

Do This For 90 Days And You'll Never Be Broke Again

EP 327

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Executive Summary

Brandon Carter makes the case that getting lean is the single highest-ROI move a man can make — boosting attractiveness, career earnings, confidence, and delayed-gratification skills — then delivers a concrete fat-loss protocol and a market/options recap with guest analyst Young Candlestick.

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Sponsor & Promo: Online Fitness Business Live Training 1:06

- Brandon is hosting a **free live training** the following day on growing an online fitness business using AI
 - Promise: show attendees how to make an extra **\$300–\$500/day** with online training
 - Applies even to complete beginners with zero clients or experience
 - Free AI tools will be given away for: scripting content, generating ideas, editing videos, and acquiring clients
- Student testimonial shown — "Will":
 - Joined the program on August 8th
 - Had a full-time job and family; just loved fitness
 - Made **\$5,940 in the last 7 days** at time of recording

- Total earned since joining (roughly one month): **over \$32,000**
- Victory Trades community plug: join for trade alerts, live trading sessions, options course, futures course, and beginner course
- Register via link in description; even if you miss the live session, sign up to get on the list for future trainings

Why Getting Lean Is the Highest ROI Investment for Men 5:34

- Brandon's core thesis: getting lean/shredded is the **#1 ROI a man can get in life**
 - Most people miscalculate the return — they think the only benefit is abs, but that is actually an "overrated" part
- Benefits extend far beyond aesthetics:
 - Improved health
 - Better perception by others
 - More confidence and discipline
 - Research links physical attractiveness to better career outcomes, academic outcomes, and higher earnings
- Getting lean is **relatively cheap** compared to other self-improvement purchases
 - It requires eating **less** — so you save money and time
 - "Abs are made by keeping your goofy ass out the kitchen"
 - Less time eating = more time for work, family, kids
- Your body goes with you **everywhere**: every business meeting, first date, vacation, photo
 - Buying an expensive watch or car while neglecting your body is "putting gift wrapping on doodoo"
 - "Your body is the vehicle in which you experience your entire life. When you improve the vehicle, you potentially improve thousands of experiences."

Getting Lean Makes You More Attractive — Including Your Face 10:21

- Attractiveness is partly fixed (height, bone structure, age) but body fat % and muscle mass are **controllable**
- Research cited: when women were asked to manipulate images of men's bodies to their preferred composition, **all women preferred muscular + low body fat**
- Fat accumulates on the **face** — making it one of the most visible signs of body composition
 - Brandon notes his own face changes significantly between bulk and cut phases
 - "90% of all looks-maxing is just getting lean"
 - People can estimate someone's body composition just by looking at their face (per research)
- What happens when you lose body fat:
 - Jawline becomes more visible
 - Waist gets smaller
 - Shoulders look wider

- Already-built muscle becomes visible
- Waist-to-shoulder V-taper is accentuated
- Getting leaner makes you **look bigger**, not smaller:
 - Brandon at 195 lbs (lean) looks bigger to people than at 205–215 lbs (bulking)
 - Michael B. Jordan in *Creed*: ~6 ft, **175 lbs**
 - Brad Pitt in *Fight Club*: under 6 ft, **~170 lbs**
 - Chris Hemsworth in first *Thor* film: ~6'2", **under 200 lbs**
- Takeaway: most guys obsessed with "getting big" actually just need to get leaner

The "Beauty Premium": Physical Attractiveness & Career Earnings 16:36

- Researchers call it the **"beauty premium"** — substantial evidence that physical attractiveness influences professional treatment
- Meta-analysis on attractiveness and job-related outcomes:
 - Attractive people received more favorable job evaluations
 - Attractive people were promoted more
- Long-term longitudinal study: men rated for facial attractiveness when young were tracked through their careers
 - More attractive men had **significantly higher earnings**
 - Earnings gap persisted into their 30s, 40s, and 50s
- Separate study following people early in careers: more attractive employees received **greater career exposure, visibility, and higher salaries** throughout their careers
- Humans make snap judgments before a word is spoken — "sizing you up" on arrival
 - "If you're not supposed to judge a book by its cover, then why the f*** do they have covers?"
- When someone sees a muscular, lean man, they assume: consistency, energy, health, self-control, discipline, focus
 - These assumptions aren't always true — but they happen universally and affect outcomes
- Your physique is part of your **personal brand**, alongside how you dress, speak, your posture, and grooming

Your Physique as a Multiplier for Everything Else 22:34

- Getting lean makes your **clothes look better**
 - A lean person in a cheap Amazon shirt looks better than an out-of-shape person in a \$5,000 designer outfit
 - "Before you continuously upgrade everything you're putting on your body, upgrade the body that's wearing it"
- Physique is a **multiplier**: the watch looks better, the suit looks better, the t-shirt looks better, vacation photos look better

- Thought experiment: two men, identical in age, income, intelligence, career, charisma — one lean and fit, one visibly out of shape
 - The fit man appears to have more control over his life
 - People would rather follow him, hire him, put him on their team
- Success and physique are **additive, not competing**:
 - You don't have to choose between making money and getting in shape
 - The combination is more powerful than either alone

Confidence, Discipline & Delayed Gratification 26:33

- 100% of people who ask Brandon "how do I get more confidence?" are not shredded — not once has a shredded person asked him this
 - Reason: if you're not confident, you probably haven't given yourself a reason to be
- Confidence comes from **evidence**, not affirmations:
 - You train when you said you would → evidence
 - You hit your steps → evidence
 - You track and hit your calories → evidence
 - Repeat hundreds of times → brain stacks up proof that "when I say I'll do something, I do it"
- The six-pack is not the most valuable thing you build — **the person capable of having a six-pack** is
- Getting lean requires **delayed gratification**: repeatedly choosing long-term benefit over short-term pleasure
 - Short-term pleasures (ice cream, video games, etc.) are typically bad long-term
 - Long-term beneficial habits (drinking a gallon of water, consistent sleep, discipline) are typically not enjoyable
- Delayed gratification is a sign of maturity; children demand immediate satisfaction — adults develop the ability to wait
- This psychological skill transfers to **every meaningful area of life**:
 - Building a business
 - Investing
 - Learning a skill
 - Building relationships
 - Creating content consistently

"While you're building your body, you're practicing the psychological skill that helps you build everything else in your life."

The Health Case: Obesity by the Numbers 31:23

- Per the **World Health Organization**: approximately **1,500 people die every day in America** from obesity-related diseases
 - For context: **3,000 people died on 9/11** — so obesity kills that many people every **other day**
 - Doesn't receive the same media coverage because deaths occur gradually, not all at once

The Exact Fat-Loss Protocol [32:47](#)

- **Calorie target**: Current body weight (lbs) × 10 = daily calorie intake
 - Example: 200 lb person → **2,000 calories/day**
- **Protein target**: 1 gram of protein per pound of **current** body weight (not goal body weight)
 - A 300 lb person → 300 g protein/day (Brandon regularly eats 250–300 g himself)
 - Reason — the **thermic effect of food** by macronutrient:

Macronutrient	Calories burned during digestion
Fat	~3% of calories consumed
Carbohydrates	10–15% of calories consumed
Protein	20–30% of calories consumed

- Practical implication: consume 100 calories of protein → body only absorbs 70–80 net calories; **2–3× more thermogenic than any other macro**
 - Also helps retain muscle during a cut
- **Steps: 20,000 steps per day** — Brandon calls this a "cheat code"; everyone who does it gets shredded
 - Sample daily schedule:
 - Morning wake-up: 30-minute walk → ~3,000 steps
 - After lunch (if you have an hour break): eat for 30 min, walk for 30 min → ~3,000 steps
 - After work: 1-hour walk (bring kids, dog, make it social) → ~6,000 steps
 - At work: get up and walk 10 minutes every hour, or use a walking pad at home
 - Estimated burn: an extra **800–1,000 calories/day**, creating a deep deficit
- **Resistance training**: Full-body workouts, 3–4 times per week
 - Pick 1–2 exercises per body part
 - 2–3 sets per exercise
 - Rest no more than 60–90 seconds between sets
 - Total session time: **45–60 minutes** (not 3 hours)
 - To speed it up: **superset opposing muscle groups**
 - Biceps immediately followed by triceps
 - Chest immediately followed by back
 - Then rest 90 seconds before next superset

- Brandon's verdict: "If you do that, it's going to be almost impossible for you to fail."

Market Recap with Young Candlestick (Greg) 40:14

- Guest: **Young Candlestick (Greg)** — licensed professional in technical analysis
- **Current S&P 500 / SPX situation:**
 - Market is selling off; clear lower high and lower low established
 - Recent high: **7,816** | Recent low: **7,643**
 - Short-term trend is **down** in September — historically the most volatile month
 - Currently retesting old all-time highs; in an area of support
 - Big bank end-of-year price target for S&P: **8,000** (currently ~7,600 → ~5% upside in 3 months)
- **Strategy 1 — Dollar Cost Averaging (DCA):**
 - Buy **VOO or SPY** regularly
 - **\$25/day into SPY** = approximately **\$3 million in 30 years** (not guaranteed)
 - Easier for most people than lump-sum investing
- **Strategy 2 — Lump Sum:**
 - Studies show throwing a lump sum (e.g., \$50,000) directly into the S&P 500 and holding long-term outperforms DCA, but psychologically harder
- **Strategy 3 — Claude AI Closing Price Predictions (Victory Trades method):**
 - Use **Claude (Sonnet model; Fable 5.1 now available)** to predict the S&P 500 closing price ~5 hours before market close
 - Track record: over 13 predictions, average error of only **~10 points**; one day was only **2 points off**
 - When prediction is accurate within 10 points → **5x–10x your money** on options
 - The prompt (screenshot in video):
 - Input: option chain from **Thinker Swim** (free account), expected move (e.g., ±\$14.94), current time, market close time, price action chart
 - Key variable: include **volume on options contracts** — high volume on a strike means price tends to gravitate there
 - Exact prompt phrasing: *"Expected move is plus or minus [X]. It's currently [time]. Market closes at [time]. Give me the dead accurate closing price of the S&P in this timeframe. Gun to your head."*
 - The "gun to your head" phrasing forces the model to commit to a single number
 - Optimal execution timing:
 - **Earlier entry (1–2 hours after open):** better risk-to-reward on the option, less accurate prediction
 - **Later entry:** more accurate prediction, but option costs more and profit is smaller
 - Trade structures:
 - **Butterfly:** higher payout but harder to hit; if Claude is off by 10 points, you may lose
 - **Iron condor (end-of-day):** give enough space → **70–80% gain**; just let it ride to expiration

- Greg plans to post the Claude prediction every day in Victory Trades
- Brandon is upgrading to **Claude Max** so Greg can run **Table 5.1** for potentially better predictions
- Member example: T. Oliver put in \$42 → **\$152 out**; did two trades → **\$220–\$250 total**
- Reason Greg focuses on **zero-day (0DTE) S&P options**: annualizing the return compounds much faster than swing trading

Individual Stock & Sector Breakdown 49:09

- **SPY end-of-year trade idea:**

- Buy 760 call, sell 800 call, expiring December 31st
- Risk: **\$2,000** to turn into **\$4,000** (1:1 risk-reward)
- Rationale: support at 760; above 800 is unlikely (would require >5% rally in 3 months)
- Friday jobs data is a key catalyst: good jobs = Fed may raise rates (hurts stocks short-term); bad jobs = Fed holds (may pump stocks)

- **Nvidia (NVDA):**

- Crushed earnings; big bullish move then went sideways
- Even Michael Burry (biggest bear) has bought Nvidia — seen as bullish signal
- Trade idea: Buy 215 call, sell 230 call, expiring **December 18, 2026**
 - Risk: **\$685** → turns into **\$1,500**
 - Seasonality: September/October bearish, November tends to bullish ahead of Thanksgiving, December Santa rally
- Brandon's note: stock is not crazy overbought, not chasing a massive run

- **TSM (Taiwan Semiconductor):**

- Greg likes it long-term; believes it **doubles over the next 3 years**
- Hard to trade short-term; going sideways
- Trade idea: Buy 390 call, sell 460 call, December expiration
 - Risk: **\$3,000** → turns into **\$7,000**
 - "Just one and done" — no need to manage actively
- Greg sold his TSM trading position (stop-out) but still holds shares long-term

- **Gold (GLD):**

- Greg sold near the top; bullish into end of 2027–2028
- If gold drops 1–2 more days, could be a buy
- Trade idea: Buy 380 call (in-the-money, preserves capital via intrinsic value), sell 435 call, December 31st
 - Risk: **\$2,300** → turns into **\$5,500** if gold hits \$435 (roughly +10% from current levels)
 - "Not too bad — double your money by end of year"

- GLD super chat note: if holding GLD shares for over 1 year, qualifies for lower long-term capital gains tax; hard stop suggestion at **\$360** (10% risk)
- **Qualcomm (QCOM):**
 - Nice base around \$167; if it breaks above **\$170**, Greg thinks it pops to **\$180–\$185** (7% gain on stock, more on calls)
- **Microsoft (MSFT):**
 - Accumulation zone: **under \$400** for about 2 months
 - Earnings were the catalyst; broke out; now at ~\$480
 - Greg says could wait to buy at \$460–480; still neutral to bullish
 - Brandon and Greg both called this publicly
- **Service Now:**
 - Greg called buy at **\$116–\$120**; stock went up **25%** and broke out; Greg fully out
- **Salesforce / CRM:**
 - Massive move off earnings (4–5 days prior at time of recording)
- **XLE (Energy sector ETF):**
 - Called as top sector of the year on **January 1st at \$44**
 - Now up **45% year-to-date** + **3% dividend** = effectively ~48% return
 - Hard to chase now; if no position, take a small amount
- **XLV (Healthcare):**
 - Called at \$150; up **16%** since then
 - Defensive sector for portfolio stabilization
- **ET (Energy Transfer):**
 - Called at **\$16**; pays **7% dividend**; up **32% year-to-date**
- **ITA (Defense sector):**
 - Did well early; has since flopped; Greg exited
- **IYT (Transports) — leading indicator:**
 - Greg called puts on transports (noted on podcast first, then alerted Victory Trades members)
 - **50% gain** on the put trade; **6% drop** in transports in just a few days
 - Drop driven by rising oil prices hurting transport companies
 - Too late to short now
- **Semiconductors (leading indicator):**
 - Down, starting to crack lower after a **90% run in ~4 months**
 - A 20% pullback from a 90% run is reasonable; Greg likes semiconductors long-term
- **Bitcoin:**
 - Broke out over **\$67K** (key level); may be worth a buy if it pulls back to **\$70K**

- Anything can happen with crypto ("could go to zero or \$10 million")
- **Tesla:**
 - Behaving well intraday; big pumps but dumps if you hold too long
- **Google / Amazon / Meta:**
 - Google: coasting, accumulating, no breakout — still liked long-term
 - Amazon: made all-time highs, slowly pulling back; in a demand zone; still liked long-term
 - Meta: chopping back and forth; no clear setup
- **Overall market takeaway:** Lots of push-pull; be super selective with swing trades; use Claude predictions in Victory Trades; DCA; be picky on long-term individual stock buys

Super Chat Q&A 1:16:24

- **Q (Visualize Wolf): Should I work two jobs (80 hrs/week) or lock in on a high-income skill like personal training?**
 - Answer: depends on your current financial situation
 - If you're broke/struggling → get more jobs and work more hours (that's what Brandon did during the recession)
 - If comfortable → keep the job, spend the other 40 hours building your business or income skill
- **Q (RA): How do I get fit and land a six-figure tech job faster when I haven't finished a big goal in a long time?**
 - On getting fit: you can lose fat fast; building muscle takes longer biologically
 - Brandon's recommendation: search "Brandon Carter two-week diet" on YouTube — his "Terminator diet"
 - People typically lose **10–15 lbs in two weeks** on it; it's intense but the fastest option
 - Now combined with tirzepatide (trespad) for even easier execution
 - On the tech job: build skills daily; spend **~4 hours a day** focused on building the skills needed for the role
- **Q (Alex): I got a new job where they see me as a "fixer" — how do I handle the pressure without stressing?**
 - Answer: the fact that a (presumably successful) company picked you means they made a deliberate, informed choice — that means something
 - Strategy: over-deliver, overperform, go super hard from day one
 - "Think about what effort you would have to put in to make failure impossible — and then do that"
- **Q: Why do you use 50g net carbs on keto instead of 20g?**
 - Answer: 50g net carbs allows vegetables and some fruits (berries) while still maintaining ketosis — more sustainable and practical
 - Added benefit: low carbs → lose water weight quickly → look more ripped immediately; also clears up skin/acne

- **Q: What do you think about a lean bulk?**
 - Brandon's approach — "micro cutting and bulking":
 - First: get as lean as you want to be
 - Then: body weight × 20 = bulk calories; eat at this level
 - When abs start disappearing or face gets fat → immediately cut back to body weight × 10
 - Oscillate between these two every **2–4 weeks** — never get fat, always gain some muscle
 - High calories are anabolic; this is why people bulk
 - This past summer was the first time in 27 years of lifting that Brandon stayed at maintenance calories the whole summer

Student Testimonials: Online Fitness Business [1:25:15](#)

- **Anna Quinn (Dallas, TX):**
 - Was an in-person trainer making essentially nothing in online coaching (~\$300 prior to joining)
 - After **8 months** in Brandon's program: made **~\$80,000** (she said "rounding up to \$80K; actually \$79,600")
 - At 22 years old — her dad told her she'd made more in the last 4 months than he had
 - Now able to start paying off student loans
- **Kelly Nicole Fit (age 23):**
 - Was a marketing major in college; goal was to never have to get a real job
 - Was selling ebooks, making \$1,000–\$2,000/month
 - After **6 months** in Brandon's program: making **almost \$20,000/month**
 - Started seeing success within the **first month** of implementing the program
 - Quote: *"I learned more stuff in this program than I did in my marketing major itself"*
- **Corey Armstrong (Detroit → Miami):**
 - Was a gym trainer in Detroit living in poverty
 - Joined Brandon's program; last month finished at **\$40,000**
 - Last full year: **\$470,000** in revenue
 - Bought his mom a car on Mother's Day and moved her out of the hood
 - Grew from **zero YouTube subscribers** to **~300,000 YouTube subscribers** and **~300,000 Instagram followers**
- Call to action: free live training, link in description; every Tuesday and Thursday → Victory Talk podcast